FEDERAL SPEC IFICATION

# PARACHUTE, METEOROLOGICAL

*This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.*

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

**1.1 Scope.**—This specification covers a paper parachute used to regulate the descent of the radiosonde after the ballon has burst.

**1.2 Classification.**—The meteorological parachute covered by this specification shall be of one type and grade only.

## 2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

**2.1** The following specifications and standard, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

*Federal Specifications:*

NN–B–591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated (for Domestic Shipment).

NN–B–621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

TT–C–595—Colors; (for) Ready Mixed Paints.

UU–P–31—Paper, General Specification and Methods of Testing.

UU–T–111—Tape, Paper, Gummed (Sealing and Securing).

LLL–B–631—Boxes; Fiber Corrugated (for Domestic Shipment).

PPP–B–601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.

*Military Specification:*

MIL–M–5658—Mildew Proofing of Fabrics, Threads and Cordages; Copper Processes for.

*Military Standard:*

MIL–STD–105—Sampling and Procedures for Inspection by Attributes.

*Signal Corps Drawing:*

No. SC–D–21566—Parachute ML–132 Assembly.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under *General Information* in the *Index of* Federal Specifications and Standards, and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.

(Copies of Military specification, standard and drawing referenced above, required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

**2.2** Specifications and other publications applicable only to individual departments are listed in section 7.

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## 3. REQUIREMENTS

**3.1 Component parts.**—The parachute shall consist of three major components, paper canopy, reed hoop, and shroud lines.

**3.2 Canopy.**

**3.2.1** *Paper.*—The canopy shall be constructed of paper which is orange-red in color and treated for water-repellency. The color shall be similar to Orange No. 1205 as indicated in Federal Specification TT–C–595. The dye used shall be waterfast. The total dry weight of the completed canopy shall not exceed 110 grams. The outer canopy shall be smooth and free from projections which will retain moisture or promote ice formations.

**3.2.2** *Tensile strength.*—The minimum tensile breaking strength of the paper shall conform to the following, when tested in accordance with 4.4.

| Sample | Minimum tensile strength |
|---|---|
| Dry, machine direction .. | 20 pounds per 1-inch width |
| Dry, cross direction .... | 6 pounds per 1-inch width |
| Wet, machine direction . | 5 pounds per 1-inch width |
| Wet, cross direction .... | 4 pounds per 1-inch width |

**3.2.3** *Bursting strength.*—The paper shall be able to withstand a Mullen test of not less than 25 pounds.

**3.2.4** *Seam strength.*—The minimum tensile breaking strength of the seams joining paper gores shall be 10 pounds when tested in accordance with 4.4.

**3.2.5** *Aging.*—The minimum dry tensile strength and minimum bursting strength of samples aged in accordance with test paragraph 4.6 shall not vary more than 20 percent from that of the unaged samples.

**3.2.6** *Temperature.*—The paper shall remain sufficiently flexible at temperatures from –94°F. to +104°F., to permit the parachute to function properly.

**3.3 Assembly of canopy.**—The canopy shall be composed of eight gores. Each gore shall be an isosceles triangle whose base is 18 inches, plus 2 inches, minus 0 inches, and whose altitude is 33 inches plus or minus 1 inch. The paper shall be cut so that the machine direction is parallel to the 18-inch base. The gores shall be assembled to form the canopy as follows:

**3.3.1** *Base sewing.*—The base of each gore shall be folded over once and hemmed ⅜ inch wide, plus or minus ⅛ inch. After the gores have been joined to form the canopy, a size E 3-ply nylon thread, having a breaking strength of not less than 8.5 pounds, shall be sewed in a continuous manner around the base of the canopy through the ⅜-inch hem. The stitching shall be ⅛ inch plus or minus 1/16 inch from the top edge of the hem. The stitching shall be of a type which will not unravel when broken. Distances between needle points shall be approximately 3/16 inch.

**3.3.2** *Joining gores.*—The sides of the gores shall be joined flush and even and seamed with a fold-over seam enclosing a tightly woven 3/16-inch cotton binding tape. The paper edges shall be folded over twice and shall completely enclose the cotton binding tape. Folding the paper edges over only once will be permitted if the resulting seam meets the strength requirements of 3.2.4, the completed parachute meets the net weight requirement of 3.7, and the cotton tape is not allowed to project beyond the seam fold. The folded seam shall be 3/16 inch, plus or minus 1/16 inch, wide. The folded seam shall be stitched in the center of the fold with cotton thread not lighter than 70/2. The stitching shall be of a type which will not unravel when broken. Distances between needle points shall be not less than 3/16 inch. If the seam is folded over once, the stitching shall pass through 4 layers of paper and 1 layer of tape. If the seam is folded over twice, the stitching shall pass through 6 layers of paper and 1 layer of tape. The cotton tape shall extend not less than 2½ inches below the gores. The cotton tape shall extend above the gores and shall be tied in a knot at such a point that the top of the canopy is completely closed



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and not more than ½ inch of the ends of the paper gores are included in the knot. The tape ends thus forming the upper tassel shall extend 8 inches, plus or minus 1 inch, from the center of the knot. The seam stitching shall extend through the tape at least 1 inch above the knot at the top of the canopy and below the canopy at the bottom.

**3.4 Hoop.**—The reed used in the loop shall be 3/16 inch, plus or minus 1/16 inch, in diameter. The reed shall be twisted, one complete twist in from 6 inches to 10 inches of length and formed into a circular hoop 18 inches, plus or minus 1 inch, in diameter. The ends of the reeds shall be lapped 5 inches, plus or minus 1 inch, and securely taped to the hoop. The ends of the reeds and any other sharp projections from the reeds shall be covered with tape. The hoop shall not break or collapse under applicable pull test of 4.8.1 or 4.9.

**3.5 Shroud lines.**—A 25-pound-test hard-twist cord shall be used for the shroud lines. Each shroud line shall be tied with a tight nonslip knot to the canopy reinforcement tape in such a manner that from 1 inch to 1½ inches of the shroud line and tape remain. Each shroud line shall be tied to the hoop in a secure and nonslip manner. These tie points shall be equally spaced around the hoop at each 45 degree of arc. The shroud line shall be tied below the hoop in a hard nonslip knot in such a manner that 8 inches plus or minus 1 inch of tassel remains. Each shroud line shall be carefully measured and tied so that the total effective lengths of the cords plus tapes between the centers of the knots in the upper and lower tassels will be approximately equal. The length of the shroud lines from the canopy to the hoop, and from the hoop to the knot forming the lower tassel, shall be as shown in figure I.

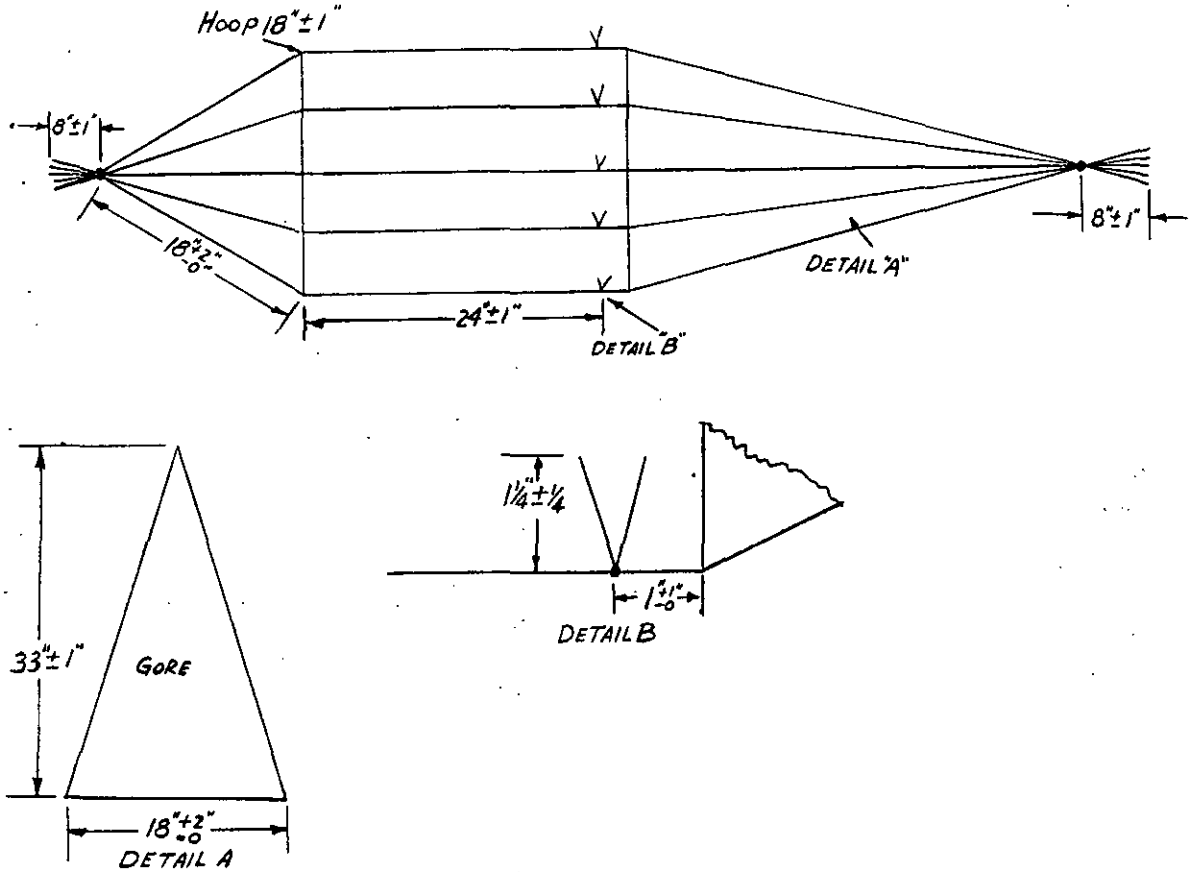



FIGURE 1.



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**3.6 Assembly of parachute.**—The completed parachute shall conform to Signal Corps Drawing No. SC–D–21566. (See 7.2.1.)

**3.7 Weight.**—The total dry weight of completed parachutes treated under Military Specification MIL–M–5658 shall not exceed 170 grams, and for untreated parachutes 150 grams.

**3.8 Ruggedness.**—The parachute shall be adaptable for field use under adverse conditions of wind, precipitation, and rough handling, and when required under section 7, shall withstand the pull test of 4.9 without ruptures, breaks, or other partial failures of sufficient consequence to affect its use as stated in 6.1.

**3.9 Sprinkling.**—The parachute shall meet the sprinkling test procedure I or II of 4.8.

**3.10 Preproduction inspection.**—Preproduction samples, when specified, may be subjected by the Government to the preproduction tests specified in table I.

**3.11 Workmanship.**—The parachute shall be manufactured and assembled in a thoroughly workmanship manner.

## 4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TEST PROCEDURES

**4.1 Inspection general.**—Inspection shall consist of the tests listed in table I, conducted in accordance with the conditions specified in 4.1.1 through 4.1.4. Samples for inspection shall be selected by the Government inspector.

**4.1.1** *Group A inspection.*—Group A shall consist of the group A inspection specified in table I and shall be performed by either of the following methods, or a combination of both:

*(a)* 100-percent inspection.

*(b)* Statistical sampling in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

The acceptable quality levels (AQL's shall be as specified in section 7 of the contract).

**4.1.1.1** *Order of inspection within group A.*—Group A inspection shall be performed in any order which is satisfactory to the Government inspector.

**4.1.2** *Group B inspection.*—When required under section 7, group B tests shall be performed on samples of materials prior to production or as appropriate on completed sample parachutes from the initial production lot to establish conformance with these requirements. Sample quantities shall be as specified in the individual test paragraphs. Thereafter, group B tests will not ordinarily be required during the course of production on a particular contract or order, but may be performed at any time deemed necessary by the cognizant inspector, if group A inspection tests indicate that the quality of the product in these respects is not being satisfactorily maintained in production.

**4.1.3** *Sampling for 50-pound pull test.*—When required under section 7 the pull test of 4.9 shall be performed on preproduction lot samples of completed parachutes selected in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105. Initially, reduced inspection procedures with inspection level I samples sizes shall apply. Normal or tightened inspection shall be instituted during the contract when required by Military Standard MIL–STD–105 and then inspection level may be raised if deemed necessary by the cognizant inspector to assure compliance with this requirement.

**4.1.4** *Disposition of rejected product.*—When rejected product (sample unit, lot, or other portion of product) is submitted for inspection, the product shall be suitably tagged or identified by equivalent means to indicate the cause of failure and means employed to correct the fault. The record shall be presented to the Government when the product is submitted and shall become the property of the Government.

**4.1.4.1** *Group A.*—Disposition of product rejected during group A inspection shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105.



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TABLE I.—*Inspection procedures*

| Inspection | Rqt. Par. | Test Par. | Preproduction | Group A | Group B |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Visual and Mechanical ..... | — | 4.2 | x | x | x |
| Weight ..... | 3.7 | 4.3 | | x | x |
| Tensile ..... | 3.2.2 and 3.2.4 | 4.4 | | | x |
| Bursting ..... | 3.2.3 | 4.5 | | | x |
| Aging ..... | 3.2.5 | 4.6 | x | | x |
| Temperature ..... | 3.2.6 | 4.7 | x | | x |
| Sprinkling—I ..... | 3.9 | 4.8.1 | x | | |
| Sprinkling—II ..... | 3.9 | 4.8.2 | | | x |
| 50-pound pull ..... | 3.8 | 4.9 | | | x |

**4.2 Visual and mechanical inspection.**—The parachute shall be inspected for workmanship, dimensions, materials, and miscellaneous defects. Examination also may be made for other visual or mechanical defects, similar to those described above, that are contrary to specified requirements. Visual and mechanical defects shall be classified by the Government inspector as major or minor in accordance with the definitions of Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

**4.3 Weight test.**—The parachute shall be weighed to determine compliance with 3.7.

**4.4 Tensile breaking strength.**—Tests shall be conducted in accordance with method 171 (dry) and method 172 (wet) of Federal Specification UU–P–31. In testing gore seam strength, the width of test machine jaws shall be 2 inches. The jaws shall grab the paper parallel with and 1½ inches from the seam and the pull shall be at right angles to the seam.

**4.5 Bursting strength.**—Tests shall be conducted in accordance with method 112 of Federal Specification UU–P–31.

**4.6 Aging.**—Representative sections of the treated paper shall be stored in an oven maintained at a temperature of 160° ± 5°F. for 72 hours. The sections shall be arranged in the oven in a manner to allow circulation of air against all surfaces of the paper. Aged samples shall then be tested in accordance with 4.4 and 4.5.

**4.7 Extreme temperature tests.**—Samples of canopy paper, similar in size and quantity to those under 4.4 shall be flexed (uncreased fold of 180° forward and backward) and twisted (180° rotation clockwise and counter clockwise) three times each, while maintained at temperatures of –94°F. and at +104°F. in a suitable chamber. There shall be no indications of brittleness.

**4.8 Sprinkling test.**

**4.8.1** *Procedure I.*—The parachute shall be held by the upper tassel and sprinkled with eight quarts of water from a sprinkling can. The temperature of the water shall be any temperature between 32°F. and 85°F. The weight of the parachute, after excess water has been shaken off shall not have increased more than 57 grams. Within 5 minutes after sprinkling, the parachute shall be able to withstand, without failure, a steady pull of 25 pounds for 1 minute, with the upper tassel secured and the pull introduced through the lower tassel. The 25-pound pull shall be applied in a gradual manner during the first 5 seconds of the 1-minute test. While under the tension, the minimum diameter of the loop shall be not less than 9 inches.



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**4.8.2** *Procedure II.*—The parachute shall be suspended from the upper tassel and subjected to a 5-minute exposure to a simulated cold water rain shower of 4 ± 1 inches per hour, produced by a spray nozzle designed to emit small water droplets rather than a fine mist. The temperature of the water shall not exceed 70°. After excess water is shaken off, the wet weight shall not exceed 210 grams.

**4.9 50-pound pull test.**—The parachute shall be suspended from the upper tassel and subjected to a 50-pound pull introduced through the lower tassel. The pull shall be applied gradually during the first 5 seconds and sustained for a period of 1 minute.

## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

**5.1 Packaging.**—Package parachutes as follows: Fold each parachute into a size of smallest possible dimensions. Inclose each parachute within a suitable style and grade kraft envelope. Properly seal closure.

**5.1.1** *Intermediate package.*—Place 10 each parachutes packaged as specified in 5.1 within a close-fitting full telescope setup box. Seal entire box closure with gummed paper tape conforming to Federal Specification UU–T–111.

**5.2 Packing.**—Place a suitable quantity of parachutes packaged as specified in 5.1.1 within wood-cleated fiberboard, wood-cleated plywood, nailed wood or corrugated fiberboard, conforming to Federal Specifications NN–B–591, PPP–B–601, NN–B–621 or LLL–B–631. Closure shall be made in accordance with the applicable box specification.

**5.3 Marking.**

**5.3.1** Unless otherwise specified, packages shall be marked with the name and style of the commodity, and the names of the manufacturer and the contractor.

**5.3.2** Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name and type of the commodity as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the quantity contained therein, the name of the contractor, the number of the contract or order, the name and address of the consignee and the gross weight.

## 6. NOTES

**6.1 Intended use.**—The parachute covered by this specification is a small paper parachute intended for attachment to and below a sounding balloon. A radiosonde weighing about 3 pounds is attached to and below the parachute. The sounding balloon bursts after lifting the radiosonde and parachute to a height up to 18 miles. The parachute is used to control the descent of the radiosonde after the balloon bursts.

**6.2 Ordering data.**—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and should specify the following (see 5.3.1, 5.3.2 and section 7):

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Whether domestic or overseas shipment is required.
(c) Samples required.
(d) Marking and shipping of samples.
(e) Place of final inspection.
(f) Acceptable quality level.

**Patent notice.**—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

## 7. DEPARTMENTAL REQUIREMENTS

**7.1** The following specifications and other publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, and special requirements, form a part of this specification for purchases made under this specification by the respective departments.

**7.2 Army, Navy, and Air Force.**



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**7.2.1** *Applicable specifications, standards and drawing.*

*Military Specifications:*

JAN–P–106—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes; Wood, Nailed.
MIL–B–107—Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
JAN–P–108—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes, Fiberboard (V-Board and W-Board), Exterior and Interior.
MIL–P–116—Preservation, Methods of.
JAN–P–117—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Bags, Interior Packaging.
JAN–P–120—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Cartons, Folding, Paperboard.
JAN–P–127—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment — Tape, Adhesive, Pressure-Sensitive, Water Resistant.
JAN–P–133—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.
MIL–M–13231—Marking of Electronic Items.

*Military Standard:*

MIL–STD–129—Marking of Shipments.

*Signal Corps Drawing:*

No. SC–DL–21565—Parachute ML–132 Drawing and Data List.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

**7.3 Requirements and tests.**

**7.3.1** *Army.*

**7.3.1.1** *Construction.*—Parachute ML–132 ( ) shall be constructed in accordance with Signal Corps Drawing SC–DL–21565 and shall meet the requirements specified in paragraphs 3.1, 3.2.1, 3.2.6, 3.7, 3.8 thru 3.11, and tests specified in 4.1, 4.1.1, 4.1.1.4, 4.1.4, 4.1.4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.7 and 4.8.1.

**7.3.1.2** *Marking.*—For Army purchases the parachute shall be designated as "Parachute ML–132–( )." Marking shall be in accordance with MIL–M–13231.

**7.3.1.3** *Preproduction requirements.*

**7.3.1.3.1** *Preproduction samples.*

**7.3.1.3.2** *Quantities.*—After award of contract, 10 preproduction samples of Parachute ML–132–( ) shall be furnished.

**7.3.1.3.3** *Compliance with specified requirements.*

**7.3.1.3.3.1** Preproduction samples shall meet specified requirements, shall be made and assembled by tools and methods that will be used for quantity production, and shall be accompanied by a statement to that effect. (See 7.3.1.3.3.3 for exception.)

**7.3.1.3.3.2** Approval of preproduction samples shall not be construed as a waiver of any specified requirement. After being released to the contractor (see 7.3.1.3.3.5), preproduction samples to be offered as units on contract shall be refabricated by the contractor, if necessary, to meet specified requirements.

**7.3.1.3.3.3** When deviation from 7.3.1.3.3.1 is unavoidable, the preproduction samples may be submitted for approval provided that the accompanying statement describes in detail, each nonconforming feature, reason therefor, and manner in which it will be corrected in production of equipment on contract.

**7.3.1.3.3.4** *Test data.*—The preproduction samples shall be accompanied by test data showing compliance with specifications and drawings. The test data shall comprise an engineering report giving test procedure, observations, and other data, calculations, test results, and essential details of the testing equipment (manufacturer's model, serial number, and the like).

**7.3.1.3.3.5** *Reference standards.*—Approved preproduction samples which are returned to the contractor's plant shall be kept intact in custody of the Government inspector, until released by him. They shall be used as reference standards to resolve any differences of opinion regarding interpretation of requirements.



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**7.3.1.4** *Inspection tests.*

TABLE I.—*Group A inspection*

| Inspection or test | Requirement paragraph | Test paragraph | AQL | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Major | Minor |
| | | | *Percent* | *Percent* |
| Visual and mechaical .. | | 4.2 | 1.0 | 4.0 |
| Weight test .. | 3.7 | 4.3 | | |

**7.3.1.4.1** *Group B inspection.*—Group B inspection shall conform to table II.

TABLE II.—*Group B inspection*

| | Requirement paragraph | Test paragraph | Table | AQL |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | *Percent* |
| Sprinkling test (procedure 1) | 3.9 | 4.8.1 | IIIa IIIb | 8 |

**7.3.1.4.2** *Sampling for group B.*—Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with tables IIIa and IIIb. Sample units shall be selected, without regard to their quality, by the Government inspector. Unless otherwise specified, normal inspection shall be used at the acceptance number specified in the sampling plan. Disposition of rejected product (sample units and lots) shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105 and 7.3.1.4.8.

**7.3.1.4.3** *Order of inspection within group B.*—Group B inspection shall be performed in any order which is satisfactory to the Government inspector.

**7.3.1.4.4** *Procedure in case of failure.*—When a lot is rejected, the contractor shall immediately investigate the cause of failure and shall report to the Government inspector the results thereof and details of the corrective action taken. If the contractor and Government inspector cannot agree on the effectiveness of the corrective action, the matter shall be referred to the contracting officer for resolution.

TABLE IIIa.—*Group B-3 sampling plans*

| Lot size (*) | Reduced (**) inspection | | Normal (**) inspection | | Tightened (**) inspection | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Sample size | Acceptance number | Sample size | Acceptance number | Sample size | Acceptance number |
| 9 to 25, incl. ..... | 2 | 0 | 2 | 0 | 4 | 0 |
| 26 to 65, incl. ..... | 2 | 0 | 2 | 0 | 4 | 0 |
| 66 to 180, incl. ..... | 5 | 1 | 5 | 1 | 11 | 1 |
| 181 to 500, incl. ..... | 5 | 1 | 11 | 2 | 18 | 2 |
| 501 to 1,300, incl. ..... | 5 | 1 | 18 | 3 | 26 | 3 |
| 1,301 to 3,200, incl. ..... | 11 | 2 | 26 | 4 | 34 | 4 |
| 3,201 to 8,000, incl. ..... | 11 | 2 | 34 | 5 | 41 | 5 |
| 8,001 to 22,000, incl. ..... | 18 | 3 | 41 | 6 | 50 | 6 |
| 22,001 and over ..... | 18 | 3 | 50 | 7 | 50 | 6 |

(*) For lot sizes under 9, the sample size shall be at the option of the Government but not more than 2, and the acceptance number shall be 0.

(**) Normal, tightened, or reduced inspection shall be used in accordance with the following: (Part "b" of this table lists values for limits A, B, and C, referenced below.)

(1) Calculate the estimated process average from the formula 100 P/N; where P equals the number of defective units found in N sample units, and N equals the number of sample units included in the estimated process average. The Government will determine the number of consecutive sample units to be used to estimate the process average.
(2) Except as stated in (3) below, use normal inspection as long as the process average is between limits A and C.
(3) Change to tightened inspection whenever the process average becomes equal to or greater than limit A, or whenever a lot fails to pass.
(4) Return to normal inspection from tightened inspection when two lots in succession pass tightened inspection, and the process average becomes less than limit B.
(5) Change to reduced inspection whenever the process average becomes less than limit C.
(6) Return to normal inspection from reduced inspection when the process average becomes equal to or greater than limit C.



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TABLE IIIb.—*Group B-3 limits of the process average*

| N | Limit A | Limit B | Limit C | N | Limit A | Limit B | Limit C |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | *Percent* | *Percent* | *Percent* | | *Percent* | *Percent* | *Percent* |
| 10 | 25.16 | 16.58 | * | 130-144 | 12.76 | 10.38 | 3.24 |
| 11 | 24.36 | 16.18 | * | 145-159 | 12.51 | 10.25 | 3.49 |
| 12 | 23.66 | 15.83 | * | 160-179 | 12.29 | 10.14 | 3.71 |
| 13 | 23.05 | 15.52 | * | 180-199 | 12.04 | 10.02 | 3.96 |
| 14 | 22.50 | 15.25 | * | 200-249 | 11.84 | 9.92 | 4.16 |
| 15-16 | 22.01 | 15.00 | * | 250-299 | 11.43 | 9.72 | 4.57 |
| 17-18 | 21.16 | 14.58 | * | 300-349 | 11.13 | 9.57 | 4.87 |
| 19-20 | 20.45 | 14.22 | * | 350-399 | 10.90 | 9.45 | 5.10 |
| 21-23 | 19.84 | 13.92 | * | 400-449 | 10.71 | 9.36 | 5.29 |
| 24-26 | 19.08 | 13.54 | * | 450-499 | 10.56 | 9.28 | 5.44 |
| 27-29 | 18.44 | 13.22 | * | 500-549 | 10.43 | 9.21 | 5.57 |
| 30-34 | 17.91 | 12.95 | * | 550-599 | 10.31 | 9.16 | 5.69 |
| 35-39 | 17.17 | 12.59 | * | 600-649 | 10.22 | 9.11 | 5.78 |
| 40-44 | 16.58 | 12.29 | * | 650-699 | 10.13 | 9.06 | 5.87 |
| 45-49 | 16.09 | 12.04 | * | 700-749 | 10.05 | 9.03 | 5.95 |
| 50-59 | 15.67 | 11.84 | 0.33 | 750-799 | 9.98 | 8.99 | 6.02 |
| 60-69 | 15.00 | 11.50 | 1.00 | 800-849 | 9.92 | 8.96 | 6.08 |
| 70-79 | 14.49 | 11.24 | 1.51 | 850-899 | 9.86 | 8.93 | 6.14 |
| 80-89 | 14.07 | 11.03 | 1.93 | 900-949 | 9.81 | 8.90 | 6.19 |
| 90-99 | 13.72 | 10.86 | 2.28 | 950-999 | 9.76 | 8.88 | 6.24 |
| 100-114 | 13.43 | 10.71 | 2.57 | 1000 | 9.72 | 8.86 | 6.28 |
| 115-129 | 13.06 | 10.53 | 2.94 | | | | |

* Number of sample units included in estimated process average is insufficient for reduced inspection.
N—Number of sample units in estimated process average.

**7.3.1.4.5** *Group C inspection.*—Group C inspection shall be as listed in table IV.

TABLE IV.—*Group C inspection*

| | Requirement paragraph | Test paragraph | AQL |
|---|---|---|---|
| Extreme temperature test | 3.26 | 4.7 | 6 specimens for each test. 1 test per month |

**7.3.1.4.6** *Noncompliance.*—If the sample unit fails group C inspection, the contractor shall immediately investigate the cause of failure and shall report to the Government inspector the results thereof and details of the corrective action taken on the process and affected portion of product. If the Government inspector does not consider that the corrective action will enable the product to meet the specified requirements, or if the contractor cannot determine the cause of failure, the matter shall be referred to the contracting officer.

**7.3.1.4.7** *Reinspection of conforming group B and group C sample units.*—Unless otherwise specified, sample units which have been subjected to and passed group B and group C inspection, or both, may be accepted on contract, provided that they are resubjected to and pass group A inspection after repair of all visible damage.

**7.3.1.4.8** *Disposition of nonconforming product.*—When defective sample units or rejected lots are resubmitted or affected portion of prod-



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uct is submitted for acceptance, such product shall be suitably tagged or identified by equivalent means to indicate the cause of failure and means employed to correct the fault. The record shall be presented to the Government when the product is submitted and shall become the property of the Government.

**7.3.2** *Navy.*

**7.3.2.1** *Construction and tests.*—For Navy purchases, materials and completed parachutes shall comply with the tests listed under group B inspection of table I in section 4 and with the related design and construction requirements of section 3.

**7.3.2.2** *Acceptable quality level.*—When not otherwise specified in contract or order AQL of 10.0 shall apply to Group A inspection of table I for Naval purchases.

**7.4 Preservation and packaging.**

**7.4.1** *Army.*

**7.4.1.1** *For domestic shipment.*—Parachute ML–132 ( ) shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with method III of Military Specification MIL–P–116.

**7.4.2** *Navy.*

**7.4.2.1** *For domestic shipment.*—The completed parachutes shall be packed in bundles of twelve each. The canopy shall be folded flat in the form of a triangle whose base is approximately 18 inches. The triangle shall be folded once lengthwise to form a trapezoid whose altitude is approximately 16 inches. The folded canopy shall then be placed on top of the hoop with all shroud lines below the canopy and the upper tassel on top. Parachutes shall be stacked on one another to complete the bundle. The shroud lines shall be so placed that when the upper tassel is grasped and raised the parachute can be lifted without tangling. Each bundle shall be placed in a suitable kraft paper bag and closure sealed, then placed in a close-fitting full telescope setup box. Seal entire box closure with gummed paper tape conforming to Federal Specification UU–T–111.

**7.4.3** *Army and Navy.*

**7.4.3.1** *For export shipment.*—Preserve and package Parachute ML–132 ( ) in accordance with procedures specified for the designated methods as prescribed in Military Specification MIL–P–116, and further described in the following paragraphs.

**7.4.3.1.1** *Parachute ML–132 ( ).*—Package each parachute method IC–3, as follows: Fold each parachute, place folded item within a close-fitting type II, class B bag, conforming to the requirements of Military Specification JAN–P–117. Properly seal closure.

**7.4.3.1.2** *Intermediate package.*—Place a suitable quantity of packaged parachutes within a close-fitting folding carton or setup box, complying with Military Specification JAN–P–120 or JAN–P–133, respectively. Seal entire closure with gummed kraft tape. The gross weight of any intermediate package shall not exceed approximately five pounds.

**7.4.3.1.3** *Consolidated package.*—Consolidate a quantity of the items, packaged as specified in 7.4.3.1.2, together within a suitable style and grade fiberboard box, conforming to Military Specification JAN–P–108. Fill all voids with flexible corrugated paper to prevent movement. Seal entire box closure, corners and joints with water-resistant pressure-sensitive tape, conforming to Military Specification JAN–P–127.

**7.4.3.2** *Packing.*

**7.4.3.2.1** *For domestic shipment.*—Parachute ML–132–( ) shall be packed in wood-cleated fiberboard, wood-cleated plywood, nailed wood, or corrugated fiberboard boxes conforming to Federal Specifications NN–B–591, PPP–B–601, NN–B–621, and LLL–B–631, respectively Clos-



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ure shall be made in accordance with applicable box specification.

**7.4.3.2.2** *For export shipment.*—Place a quantity of the items consolidated packages specified in 7.4.3.1.2 within a wood-cleated plywood, nailed wood or wire bound wood box conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification PPP–B–601, Military Specifications JAN–P–106 and MIL–B–107, respectively. Fabricate the boxes to fit contents snugly. The approximate gross weight of any exterior shipping container shall not exceed 150 pounds. Close the shipping container as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

**7.4.3.2.3** Shipping containers shall be strapped in conformance with the requirements of the appendix of the applicable container specification only for direct shipment to ports.

**7.4.3.2.4** *Marking of shipment.*—Interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with applicable provisions of Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

**MILITARY INTEREST:**

**Army—Sig**
**Navy—A**
**Air Force—USAF**

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 15 cents.



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